FiTEN Business Directory

A Year-Round B2B Platform for Tamil Entrepreneurs

Connecting Tamil Entrepreneurs — Across Borders, Across Industries, Year-Round

THE OPPORTUNITY

FiTEN has spent **40 years** building one of the most connected Tamil entrepreneur networks in North America. But that network lives in event halls — **not online**. When the FiTEN Edison conference ends, connections disappear. There is no searchable directory, no persistent profile, no way for a Tamil founder in New Jersey to find a Tamil software agency in Chennai.

The **FiTEN Business Directory** changes that — turning the network into a year-round platform that is searchable, trusted, and built exclusively for Tamil B2B commerce.

~600K	71	3,000+
Tamil People in the US & Canada	**Member Tamil Sangams in FeTNA**	**FeTNA Convention Attendees (2025)**
US & Canadian Census	FeTNA.org verified	South Asian Herald, 2025

WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

A searchable, bilingual (English + Tamil) B2B networking platform on fiten.org — with six capabilities no general platform offers:

■ **B2B Networking**	Founders signal: *Open to Partnership / Seeking Investment / Available for Mentorship*. Tamil entrepreneurs connect by industry, geography, stage, and intent.
■ **Investor–Startup Pipeline**	Tamil startups flag funding stage and sector. Tamil VCs filter by stage, geography, and industry — the only structured Tamil investor-startup matching infrastructure in existence.
■ **Cross-Border Commerce**	Tamil IT firms in Chennai find US Tamil clients. Tamil founders in New Jersey source culturally-aligned vendors in India. One platform bridging both sides of the Tamil business world.
■ **Persistent FiTEN Event Identity**	Every speaker, exhibitor, and award winner receives a permanent profile. Event history lives on the directory indefinitely — not just in a conference programme.
■ **Verified Trust Badge**	"Verified FiTEN Member" badge — free for all active members. A trust signal backed by 40 years of FeTNA credibility that no Google star rating can match.
■ **Bilingual (EN + Tamil)**	Full English and Tamil-script interface. Tamil-language descriptions and search serve both diaspora and Tamil Nadu-based businesses.

WHY ONLY FiTEN CAN DO THIS

40 Years of FeTNA Trust	No competitor can build overnight what FeTNA has earned over four decades. The "Verified FiTEN Member" badge carries community credibility that no algorithm or star rating can replicate. For high-stakes B2B decisions — choosing a legal partner, a financial advisor, a tech agency — this matters.
A Network Already Built	FiTEN doesn't need to grow its user base from zero. 1,000+ annual event attendees, 100+ Sangams, and a living roster of speakers, exhibitors, and award winners are the founding members. No cold-start problem.
No Competitor Comes Close	Google finds Tamil restaurants for consumers. LinkedIn has no Tamil filter. Facebook groups have no structured profiles. India-specific directories don't cover the diaspora. **Not one platform combines Tamil identity, B2B networking, investor matching, and event identity.**
Cross-Border Context is Unique	A Tamil IT firm in Chennai wanting US Tamil clients has nowhere to signal this today. A Tamil founder in New Jersey cannot filter for Indian vendors by shared cultural context. FiTEN is the only organization with the credibility and community to bridge both sides of this market.

THE LISTING MODEL

Two tiers — simple and focused. **The "Verified FiTEN Member" badge is free** for all active members; the Pro tier adds full visibility, B2B tools, and event history.

FREE — Community	PRO · $29/mo or $290/yr
Searchable listing (name, category, location)	Everything in Free, plus:
Contact info & website link	Logo + up to 5 photos
Short description (English)	Full bilingual description (English + Tamil)
Verified FiTEN Member badge	Social media links
	Priority search placement
	Customer reviews enabled
	B2B connection requests (partnership, investment, mentorship)
	Monthly Tamil business email digest inclusion
	Owner analytics dashboard (views, clicks, inquiries)

ROLLOUT AT A GLANCE

Phase 1	**Mo 1–3**	English directory: search, profiles, admin panel, mobile-optimised. Pro tier goes live. 100 founding members onboarded.
Phase 2	**Mo 4–6**	Full Tamil language, verified badges, B2B connections, partnership signals, FiTEN event integration. All Pro features fully active.

Phase 3	**Mo 7–9**	Investor–startup matching, co-founder search, owner analytics dashboard, sponsored placements.
Phase 4	**Mo 10+**	AI-powered recommendations, Tamil Nadu startup registry integration, global Tamil association API access.

FIVE STEPS TO LAUNCH

1. Board Approval	FiTEN Executive Committee approves proposal and authorises Phase 1 budget. **Target: within 30 days.**
2. Appoint Directory Lead	Designate a board member or trusted community leader as project owner and single point of accountability.
3. Recruit Developers	Open call to FiTEN / FeTNA community. Target: 2–3 volunteer developers committed before any contracting begins.
4. 100 Founding Listings	Recruit 100 businesses from the existing member network. Incentive: **free lifetime Pro tier** — before public launch.
5. Build & Soft Launch	90-day Phase 1 build. Soft launch at the next FiTEN Edison event — live kiosk demo, QR code sign-up, founding business showcase.

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